

Post-incident review PIR-2025-036

Search Service: degraded latency

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 24 February 2025, Search Service experienced degraded latency in production (AU East) for about 40 minutes. The end-to-end checkout probe went red. Investigation found that a DNS record was repointed during a migration while the old target was still serving writes.

Impact

Users of Search Service saw degraded latency for about 40 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:05 First signal received.
- 09:38 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:43 Likely cause identified.
- 10:15 Mitigation applied.
- 10:58 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a DNS record was repointed during a migration while the old target was still serving writes.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.